

SI-MI: Social Identity Matters in Mentoring

Session 2: Identity and Its Intersections

Guiding question: How do my identities influence the way I mentor or am mentored?

Overview: This session explores how identity and intersectionality shape experiences in STEM and mentoring relationships. Participants will reflect on their own identities, consider how systems of privilege and marginalization operate, and examine how intersecting identities can influence what mentees experience in academic settings.

Objectives:

- Define identity and intersectionality in the context of mentoring and STEM.
- Reflect on how personal identities and biases shape mentoring relationships.
- Recognize how intersecting identities can create distinct opportunities and challenges for mentees.

Before the Session: Complete the assigned pre-work and come ready to reflect on identity, privilege, and intersectionality. Be prepared to connect the ideas from the pre-work to your own experiences in STEM and to mentoring scenarios.

- **Complete:** [The Academic Wheel of Privilege](#) activity
- **Watch:** [TED Talk - The Urgency of Intersectionality](#) by Kimberlé Crenshaw
- **Read:** [15 Examples of Intersectionality](#)

What to Expect in the Live Session: The live session will combine individual reflection, breakout conversations, and larger group discussion. Participants will explore how identity influences participation in STEM and will apply an intersectional lens to broad mentoring case examples.

Takeaways: After this week, you should be able to:

- Recognize how identity and intersectionality influence experiences in mentoring and STEM
- Reflect on how your own identities and biases shape mentoring relationships
- Apply an intersectional perspective when considering mentee experiences and mentoring practices